Look Before the Lever

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 5

At the approach, Nib reached toward a handle. Lark opened the how-to page. Its first picture showed a person looking from the dry platform with a notebook. The handle belonged to a later step. Moving it now would change the very arrangement they wanted to understand.

“A lever with possibilities,” Nib whispered eagerly. “A look before a lever,” Lark reminded him gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **if**

“Read the instructions in order, keeping their goal in view,” Lark explained gently. “Look and record come before change. First and then help us connect the steps. We can leave the page open beside its matching pictures rather than remember every word at once.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try look, first, then. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the first two directions,” Lark invited gently. “Which action belongs before touching a control?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **First look at the gate. Then make a note.**

“What comes before making the note?” Lark asked gently. “Does either sentence ask us to move the gate?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib put his paw back beside the notebook. They followed the dry approach and stopped at the fixed viewing position. The gate was visible, but a loose old label made the alternate channel hard to identify. They recorded that uncertainty instead of moving the gate to see what happened.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write first beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the untouched scene. The next job was matching labels to their real anchors, so the crew could describe the channels accurately before testing an explanation.